

DEPOSIT & CANCELLATION POLICY

For customer quotations and project bookings · September 2026

This policy explains how GJ Builders handles deposits, booking of works, customer cancellations and costs incurred before or during a project. It is intended to be read alongside the quotation/estimate and any other written terms agreed for the individual project.

1. Deposit & Booking Requirements

- **Standard deposit:** A deposit of 10% of the agreed contract price is normally required to secure the booking and reserve the agreed start period.
- The deposit is payable once the quotation has been accepted and before the project is formally booked.
- For larger projects, substantial advance purchases, specialist materials, plant or subcontractors, a different deposit or stage-payment schedule may be requested and will be stated in the quotation or agreed in writing.
- The deposit contributes towards planning and preparing for the project, reserving labour/time, arranging plant and deliveries, and committing to the agreed start period.

2. Payment During Project

- Projects lasting several weeks may require agreed stage payments rather than payment only at completion.
- Stage payments will be set out in the quotation or agreed in writing.
- Invoices are payable by the date stated. Where an agreed payment remains outstanding, GJ Builders may pause works, subject to the contract and applicable law.

3. Customer Cancellation

If a customer cancels after accepting the quotation and/or paying the deposit, GJ Builders will assess the financial effect of the cancellation. The customer may be responsible for costs and losses directly caused by the cancellation, including:

- Materials already ordered specifically for the project where the cost cannot reasonably be cancelled or recovered.
- Plant, machinery, scaffolding, skips, deliveries or other hire/services already booked where cancellation or recovery charges apply.
- Subcontractor or specialist bookings that cannot reasonably be cancelled without cost.
- Labour or other costs already incurred as a direct result of preparing for the agreed start date.
- Other demonstrable direct costs resulting from the cancellation, after GJ Builders has taken reasonable steps to minimise the loss.

4. Short-Notice Cancellation

Short notice means cancellation within **1 week** of the agreed start date.

Where a project is cancelled within 1 week of the agreed start date, particularly after labour, plant, materials or deliveries have been committed, GJ Builders may invoice the customer for direct costs that cannot be avoided or recovered.

5. Postponement / Change of Start Date

- Customers may request to postpone the agreed start date provided the request is made at least **3 weeks** before the scheduled start date. Where sufficient notice is given, GJ Builders will normally accommodate the postponement and agree a revised start date, subject to availability.
- Any request to postpone made less than 3 weeks before the scheduled start date must be discussed with GJ Builders. GJ Builders will consider the circumstances and any costs or commitments already made, including labour, plant, materials, deliveries and subcontractors.
- A postponement requested less than 3 weeks before the start date may result in reasonable direct costs being payable where GJ Builders has already incurred costs that cannot reasonably be cancelled or recovered.

6. Deposit Refunds & Cancellation Costs

- Any refund or retained deposit will be considered in light of the actual circumstances of the cancellation.
- GJ Builders will not recover the same loss twice. Any amount retained or charged will be limited to what is reasonably due under the agreed contract and applicable law.

7. Customer Legal Rights

Nothing in this policy removes or restricts any statutory rights the customer may have under applicable UK consumer law. The policy is intended to operate fairly and proportionately. Any cancellation charge should reflect genuine direct loss or costs incurred rather than operate as a penalty.

8. Acceptance

By accepting the quotation and paying the required deposit, the customer confirms that they have had the opportunity to read this policy and understand that cancellation or short-notice postponement may result in direct costs where GJ Builders has incurred costs in preparation for the project.

PROJECT DETAILS

Customer	_____	Project address	_____
Quotation / contract value	£ _____	Deposit required	£ _____
Agreed start date	_____		

CUSTOMER ACCEPTANCE

Signature: _____
 Name: _____
 Date: _____

GJ BUILDERS

Signature: _____
 Name: _____
 Date: _____